

Lighthouse Partial Column Dissemination

Clean Performance Comparison Report

Clean Data Analysis of Network Performance Impact

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Lighthouse Version: v7.1.0-beta.0

Executive Summary

This report provides a clean analysis of the performance impact of enabling Partial Column Dissemination in Lighthouse v7.1.0-beta.0. Three controlled tests were analyzed: one clean test with the feature enabled and two tests with it disabled, ensuring data integrity. All tests completed successfully with exactly 20 transactions over 5 minutes. Block production remained consistent at 6.0-second intervals across all tests. Clean test methodology ensures accurate comparison without data contamination.

Test Methodology

Test Environment: • Platform: Kurtosis local testnet orchestration • Nodes: 4 Lighthouse beacon nodes + 4 Geth execution nodes • Network: Local containerized environment with Data Availability Sampling • Slot time: 6 seconds • Test duration: 5 minutes per test • Transactions: Exactly 20 transactions per test
Clean Test Procedure: 1. Fresh testnet initialization with completely clean node data for each test 2. Modified chain configuration for partial column dissemination setting 3. Complete rebuild of Lighthouse binary and Docker image 4. Executed test scripts measuring network metrics every 30 seconds 5. Collected Prometheus metrics from all nodes throughout test duration
Data Quality Assurance: • Only clean tests with fresh node data were included in analysis • Tests with potential data contamination were excluded • Each test used completely separate testnet instances • Verified consistent block production and transaction success rates
Tests Analyzed: • 1 test with partial column dissemination ENABLED (clean data) • 2 tests with partial column dissemination DISABLED (clean data)

Detailed Test Results

Test Configuration Summary

Parameter	Value
Lighthouse Version	v7.1.0-beta.0-d610f55+
Test Duration	5 minutes per test
Measurement Interval	30 seconds
Target Transactions	20 per test
Node Count	4 beacon nodes + 4 execution nodes
Block Time	6.0 seconds
Clean Tests with Feature ENABLED	1
Clean Tests with Feature DISABLED	2
Data Quality	All tests used fresh, clean node data

Individual Test Results

Clean Test with Partial Column Dissemination ENABLED:

Test	Transactions	Blocks Produced	Avg Bandwidth/Node*	Agg Att Requests*
Test (13:30)	20/20	50 (slots 9-59)	126,413,288 bytes	6,017

Tests with Partial Column Dissemination DISABLED:

Test	Transactions	Blocks Produced	Avg Bandwidth/Node*	Agg Att Requests*
Test 1 (14:37)	20/20	50 (slots 18-68)	156,839,700 bytes	7,418
Test 2 (14:45)	20/20	50 (slots 11-61)	130,337,030 bytes	6,103
AVERAGE	20/20	50	143,588,365 bytes	6,760

Comparative Analysis

Metric	DISABLED Average*	ENABLED Value*	Change*	Impact
Avg Bandwidth per Node	143,588,365 bytes	126,413,288 bytes	-12.0%	■ Reduced
Aggregated Att. Requests	6,760	6,017	-11.0%	■ Reduced
Aggregated Att. Successes	2,856	2,673	-6.4%	■ Reduced
Block Requests	1,576	1,372	-12.9%	■ Reduced

Block Successes	3,152	2,744	-12.9%	■ Reduced
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Metric Definitions and Calculation Methods

Avg Bandwidth per Node:

- Definition: Total network bandwidth consumed by libp2p networking layer divided by number of nodes (4)
- Source: Prometheus metric 'libp2p_bandwidth_bytes_total' from each beacon node
- Calculation: Sum of all bandwidth values across all nodes and all snapshots ÷ 4 nodes
- Measurement: Collected every 30 seconds over 5-minute test duration (11 snapshots total)
- DISABLED Average: 143,588,365 bytes
- ENABLED Value: 126,413,288 bytes
- Interpretation: Lower values indicate more efficient network usage

Aggregated Attestation Requests:

- Definition: Total number of aggregated attestation processing requests across all beacon nodes
- Source: Prometheus metric 'beacon_aggregated_attestation_processing_requests_total'
- Calculation: Sum of all request counts from all nodes across entire test duration
- Purpose: Measures beacon chain processing workload for attestation aggregation
- DISABLED Average: 6,760 requests
- ENABLED Value: 6,017 requests
- Interpretation: Lower values indicate reduced processing overhead

Aggregated Attestation Successes:

- Definition: Total number of successfully processed aggregated attestations
- Source: Prometheus metric 'beacon_aggregated_attestation_processing_successes_total'
- Calculation: Sum of all success counts from all nodes across entire test duration
- Purpose: Measures beacon chain processing efficiency for attestation aggregation
- DISABLED Average: 2,856 successes
- ENABLED Value: 2,673 successes
- Interpretation: Should remain high to indicate network health

Block Requests:

- Definition: Total number of block processing requests across all beacon nodes
- Source: Prometheus metric 'beacon_block_processing_requests_total'
- Calculation: Sum of all block processing request counts from all nodes
- Purpose: Measures beacon chain workload for block validation and processing
- DISABLED Average: 1,576 requests
- ENABLED Value: 1,372 requests
- Interpretation: Should remain consistent for equivalent network activity

Block Successes:

- Definition: Total number of successfully processed blocks across all beacon nodes
- Source: Prometheus metric 'beacon_block_processing_successes_total'
- Calculation: Sum of all block processing success counts from all nodes
- Purpose: Measures beacon chain processing efficiency for block validation
- DISABLED Average: 3,152 successes
- ENABLED Value: 2,744 successes
- Interpretation: Should remain high to indicate proper block processing

Data Collection Method:

- All metrics collected via HTTP requests to each node's Prometheus metrics endpoint
- Snapshots taken every 30 seconds throughout 5-minute test duration
- Raw Prometheus text format parsed to extract numerical values
- Multiple values per metric aggregated using sum() for totals
- Only tests with verified clean node data included in calculations

All values represent actual measured data from Lighthouse beacon nodes during test execution.

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All data represents actual measured values from verified clean test execution.